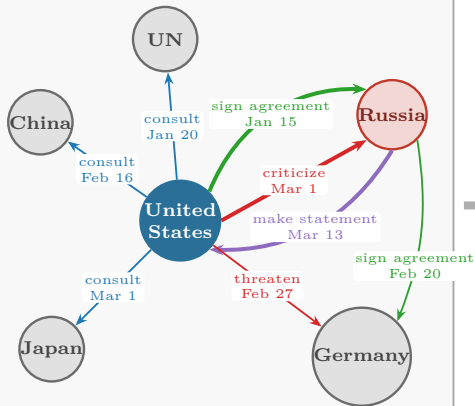


1 What happened so far

countries, linked by events that have a type and a date



bold arrows: everything that happened between the United States and Russia, in both directions

2 The question, read two ways

Whom will the United States consult on Mar 14?

The usual way: look only at whom the US **consulted** before.

China Japan UN

Russia is not on this list, so it cannot be the answer.

ECHO: look at everything that happened between the US and each country, in order.

US & Russia:

statement
Mar 13

criticize
Mar 1

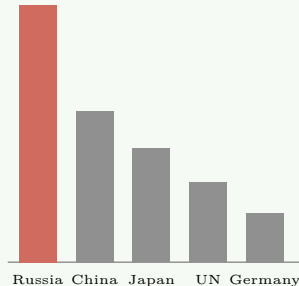
agreement
Jan 15

Two countries this busy with each other are likely to talk next, even though they have not “consulted” before.

3 The answer

ECHO ranks every country;
the true answer was Russia

1st



the usual way would have put
China first and Russia last